

Problem 2. Taa Answers

2.1	9. <i>Did I eat the young mudwasp [that wanted the egg]?</i>
	10. <i>Do the men not eat the buchu powder [that I touched]?</i>
	11. <i>The woman's springbok [that he looks at] was stuck on the grass.</i>
2.2	12. é n̄ n̄ xũ + kã dàã ã ðãã !xaã + tã n̄ qhúa dt'kx'ába + ke n̄ e bòkòsè qye kã [4]
	13. é qáe qye + te n̄ à núa ke + n̄ gùm kã dtsháã quã [3]
	14. èh à qhúa káni + kã ðgúã qhaã + tã xàã à kùhm kã [3]
	15. á gà'ã qhaã + tã n̄ qhúa kùhm + kã dàã kã + à xũ kã gāã ã ðgúã [4]

Q 2.1 Max 9. For each sentence, award 3p if correct; 2p with one mistake; 1p with two mistakes. A mistake includes e.g. wrong tense, missing question, misattributed relative clause, etc.

Q 2.2 Max 14. In each region separated by a +, award 1p if correct.

Q 2.3 Max 23. 11p for syntax; 8p for gender agreement; 4p for verbal markings.

Problem 2. Taa Explanations

1. Word order:

- S V **kV** 0
- Question: |**ǁ** ...
- Relative clause: **tV ... kV**
- Noun + (Adjective) + (Relative Clause)
- Tense + (Neg) + Verb
- Possessor + |**V** + Possessed

2. Gender agreement:

- Nouns are divided into two classes: Class 2 (ending in **-ǁ**) and Class 3 (ending in **-e**).
- Pronouns: **ǁ** = 1SG, **ǁh** = 3SG, both of which are in Class 3.
- Final vowel of adjective agrees with the head noun
- |**ǁ** agrees with the subject
- **kV** precedes the object and agrees with it
- **tV ... kV** agree with the head noun
- |**V** agrees with the possessed noun

3. Verbs:

- **ǁ** for the present, **ǁh** for the past
- The negative particle is **ǁqhúǁ**

Additional notes:

Actually, Taa has five noun classes, and it is often difficult to determine the noun class from the form of the noun. However, the above rule is generally true, and the nouns in this problem reflect it.

In Taa, fundamentally toneless syllables are assigned surface tones through a process involving tone classes. Each noun belongs to one of two tone classes (class I or II), which affects the tone of any modifiers that lack an inherent tone (class I nouns assign mid tones to all syllables of all modifiers; class II nouns assign a low tone to the ultima and a high tone to the penult, if there is one). Furthermore, verbs take a tone class as well, producing similar phenomena.

To avoid this complexity, in the above analysis, fundamentally toneless syllables are marked without tone.

References and further reading:

- Traill, A. (2009). *A !Xóǀ Dictionary*. (2nd edition). Volume 9 of Quellen zur Khoisan-Forschung.